

occurrence of a deadlock.

Given the interest in weather change, you may be interested in the earth science models. Some of the results would seem very reasonable; for example, the spread of a fire in a forest depends on the density of the trees. However, the non-linear increase in the extent of damage is disconcerting. The simple model just looks for a tree in the vicinity of each burning tree to determine whether the fire will continue or stop.

An example of a model that was not very obvious to me was that of the termites in the biology group.

The termites follow a set of simple rules. Each termite starts

wandering randomly. If it bumps into a wood chip, it picks the chip up, and continues to wander randomly. When it bumps into another wood chip, it finds a nearby empty space and puts its wood chip down. With these simple rules, the wood chips eventually end up in a single pile.

Finally, here's a model which affects us all—traffic. The basic traffic model illustrates the phenomenon of jams occurring for no apparent reason as the density of vehicles on the road increases. Apart from the number of cars on the road, the parameters affecting the jams are the acceleration and deceleration rates.

The true benefit of NetLogo and similar tools lies in modelling strategies before implementing policies and, hence, minimising adverse side effects. For example, it would make sense to first evaluate the implications and risks of an HR policy on increments and promotions, and study its effect on productivity, attrition, cooperation, etc, before implementing it. **END** 

By: Dr Anil Seth

The author has earned the right to do what interests him. You can find him online at <http://sethanil.com>, <http://sethanil.blogspot.com>, and reach him via email at anil@sethanil.com.

ELECTRONICS B2B INDUSTRY IS NOW AT A CLICK OF A BUTTON!

ELECTRONICS BAZAAR

launches

electronicsb2b.com



A portal rich in news, views and articles



- ✓ Features your latest products
- ✓ Know about the latest technologies & innovations
- ✓ Hook the right distributors & dealers
- ✓ Know the leading players in the industry
- ✓ Know about the manufacturing techniques & best practices
- ✓ Know about the emerging sectors & the business potentials they hold

Log on to www.electronicseb2b.com and be in touch with the Electronics B2B Fraternity 24x7

EFY Enterprises Pvt Ltd

D-87/1, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase 1,
New Delhi-110020; Ph.: 011-26810601-03